



have suffered in the past. It is feared that women may be left behind due to their past exclusion from technology. Though they do lag behind in Internet use, they are fast catching up with the men. Women formed only 38 per cent of Internet users in the US during late '90s, but overtook men by 2000. In India too this share is rising—the male-female ratio in terms of Internet usage is expected to reach 60:40 soon. Technology offers hope of more rapid convergence across the digital and urban-rural divides, particularly acute among women. Internet-based community centres, cyber cafes and kiosks are helping improve Internet access and equity in accessing the World Wide Web as also in imparting net usage skills at low cost. Though it is a rare old woman who acquires these skills, the range of new possibilities has motivated their daughters to seek e-education.

More women are fast taking up white-collar jobs partly because their people skills are better. Though there are always exceptions to any generalisation, a woman does not have to behave like a man to succeed. Research suggests that women tend to be more respectful towards their co-workers and are, thus, better at enhancing governance and creating social capital. The micro-credit movement has been hugely successful because of its focus on women. Reservation of one-third panchayat and pradhan positions has only improved the rural milieu, proving the importance of giving them political and civic power. Women have been known to spend more on public amenities such as water and roads, directly affecting their own gender. It is a well-known fact that activism is a by-product of group activities, something that most of them enjoy. So, it should come as no surprise that women groups have been at the forefront of

THE THIRD WAVE OF DEVELOPMENT, SHOWING SIGNS OF UPLIFTING WOMEN, MAKES IT IMPERATIVE FOR BOTH SEXES TO SHARE THE MALE AND FEMALE VALUES